

Plants for summer beds

With a vast choice of flowers for summer beds, making a selection for your garden will be easier if you first decide on the look you want to create.

Beds filled with an assortment of roses and perennials will produce a traditional cottage style, while bold groups of stiff-stemmed herbaceous plants convey a more contemporary design. Include perennials in groups of three or more to prevent a spotty, discordant appearance and choose a range of plants that flower consecutively to avoid a lull late in the season. Shasta daisy, beardtongue, and Russian sage will all help to link summer with fall to produce a continuous display, while fuchsia, hydrangea, and repeat-flowering roses provide great value, blooming for many months.



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Anthemis tinctoria

GOLDEN MARGUERITE Try this clump-forming perennial in a mixed bed with blue or pink perennials that contrast with its white or yellow daisy-like summer flowers and feathery aromatic leaves. 'E.C. Buxton' (above) has lemon-yellow flowers.

↑→3ft (1m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-7



PERENNIAL SMALL

Campanula punctata

SPOTTED BELLFLOWER A compact perennial that is perfect for the front of a moist bed. Its light green leaves and pendent, tubular, cream or dusky pink bell-shaped flowers make good companions for cranesbill and phlox.

↑12in (30cm) ↔16in (40cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-8



SHRUB MEDIUM

Ceanothus americanus

NEW JERSEY TEA This is a dense, rounded deciduous shrub that bears clusters of small, white scented flowers from late spring to midsummer. It is best planted at the back of a border with plants in front that provide color in summer.

↑→6ft (2m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-8 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Achillea 'Fanal'

YARROW Plant this perennial with its flat heads of yellow-centered bright red flowers and ferny green foliage, in the middle of a bed for a splash of summer color. It contrasts well with blue flower spikes.

↑30in (75cm) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3-9



PERENNIAL SMALL

Calamintha nepeta

LESSER CALAMINT This perennial makes good edging for a wildlife summer bed. Its spikes of tiny lilac-pink flowers from late summer to early fall attract bees, and the small green leaves provide background color.

↑18in (45cm) ↔30in (75cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5-9



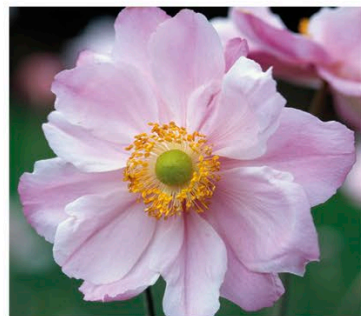
SHRUB SMALL

Cistus x dansereau

ROCK ROSE Provide a sunny, sheltered site for this evergreen shrub with gray-green leaves and a succession of papery, white, pink, or purple bowl-shaped flowers in summer. 'Decumbens' (above) has white blooms with purple central blotches.

↑24in (60cm) ↔3ft (1m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z8-10



PERENNIAL LARGE

Anemone x hybrida

JAPANESE ANEMONE Ideal for the back of a shady bed, this upright perennial produces white or pink flowers on tall stems from late summer to fall above divided leaves. 'Queen Charlotte' (above) has pale pink semidouble blooms.

↑4ft (1.2m) ↔indefinite

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-8



PERENNIAL LARGE

Campanula lactiflora

MILKY BELLFLOWER This upright branching perennial has tall back-of-bed varieties, and shorter forms, such as the violet-blue 'Prichard's Variety' (above) for the front. Blue, pink, or white, nodding bell-shaped flowers appear in summer.

↑up to 4ft (1.2m) ↔24in (60cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z5-7



CLIMBER MEDIUM

Clematis 'Abundance'

CLEMATIS Use this deciduous clematis with its twining stems of midgreen leaves and creamy yellow-centered wine-red flowers from midsummer to late fall to cover a large shrub at the back of a bed.

↑10ft (3m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4-9